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THE INFINITY HACK '26

ONE PROBLEM. THREE HOURS.
REAL SOLUTIONS.

OFFICIAL PARTICIPANT RULEBOOK & GUIDELINES

DATE	VENUE	TEAM SIZE	BUILD TIME
7 October 2026	COMSATS University Islamabad, Lahore Campus, C Block	4 Participants	3 Hours

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BUILD. DEMO. EXPLAIN.

01 / THE CHALLENGE

The official problem statement will be revealed by the organizers at the start of the hackathon.

- All teams will work on the same assigned problem and must build a functional MVP within the given 3-hour development period.
- Teams cannot replace the official problem with their own idea.
- The objective is to build a working Minimum Viable Product (MVP) – not a complete production-ready application.

02 / TEAM STRUCTURE RECOMMENDED · NOT MANDATORY

Each team must consist of exactly 4 registered participants.

The roles below are only a recommendation. They are not mandatory. Teams are free to divide responsibilities in whatever way suits their members' skills. The only fixed rule is that only the four registered members may contribute to the solution.

RECOMMENDED ROLES

M1 Frontend / UI Developer

Responsible for:

- Application interface
- User experience
- Frontend functionality
- Dashboard and screens

M2 Backend Developer

Responsible for:

- Backend logic
- Database
- APIs
- Authentication and data management

M3 AI / Integration Developer

Responsible for:

- AI implementation
- LLM / API integration
- Prompt and structured-output handling
- Connecting AI features with the application

M4 Product & Full-Stack Developer

Responsible for:

- Product flow
- Frontend / backend integration
- Testing
- Final feature integration
- Demo and presentation support

03 / DEVELOPMENT TIME

Teams will have 3 hours to develop their MVP. Development must begin only after the official problem statement has been announced.

When the development time ends:

- Coding must stop.
- The final version must be submitted.
- Teams must prepare for their demo / presentation.

Late submissions may not be accepted.

04 / AI TOOLS POLICY AI IS ALLOWED

Participants may use any AI-powered development tool, including ChatGPT, Claude, Cursor, GitHub Copilot, Gemini, Codex and other AI coding or development tools.

AI may be used for: coding, debugging, brainstorming, research, UI development, documentation, code generation, problem-solving and understanding technical concepts.

There is no penalty for using AI tools. However, every team must understand the solution they submit. Judges may ask participants to explain their code, architecture, AI implementation, database, APIs, logic, and technical decisions.

A team that cannot explain its own implementation may lose marks during evaluation.

05 / AI API KEYS & RESOURCES ARRANGE BEFORE THE EVENT

If your solution uses an AI model or any external API, you are responsible for obtaining your own API keys and resources. API keys will not be provided by the organizers.

Prepare in advance. Please arrange all required keys and accounts before the hackathon. Your project will most likely need an AI API key, and 3 hours is too short to spend on sign-ups and setup.

FREE OPTION: OPENROUTER

OpenRouter can be used to access a wide range of AI models through one API, including free models, so you can build without paying. You may use any model of your choice.

- Create your OpenRouter account and generate your API key before the event.
- Test your key with a simple request so you know it works.
- Keep a backup option ready (another model or provider), because free models can have rate limits or availability changes.
- Keep keys private: store them in environment variables and never commit them to a public repository.
- Each team manages its own keys and usage. Teams must not share code or keys in a way that breaks the team-to-team rules.

06 / EXTERNAL HELP

Only the 4 registered team members may work on the project. A fifth person cannot:

- Write code
- Fix bugs
- Design the solution
- Develop APIs
- Configure the database
- Build features
- Prepare part of the submission

External developers, friends, freelancers, mentors or other unregistered participants cannot develop any part of the solution.

AI assistance is allowed. External human development assistance is not.

07 / TEAM-TO-TEAM COLLABORATION

Every team must compete independently. Teams cannot:

- Share source code with another competing team
- Build features for another team
- Debug another team's solution
- Copy another team's implementation
- Combine solutions with another team
- Provide substantial technical assistance to another competing team

General discussion is acceptable, but the actual solution must be developed independently by each team.

08 / INTERNET & DEVELOPMENT RESOURCES

Participants may use the internet for legitimate development purposes. Teams may use:

- AI tools
- APIs
- Open-source libraries
- Frameworks
- SDKs
- Documentation
- Development platforms
- Package managers
- Public technical resources

Existing libraries and frameworks are allowed. However, teams cannot submit a complete pre-built project as if it were developed during the hackathon.

Each team should bring its own:

- Laptop
- Charger
- Required software
- Development environment
- AI API keys and accounts, ready to use
- Any other necessary equipment

09 / ORIGINALITY

The final MVP must genuinely represent the team's work during the hackathon. Teams must not:

- Copy another team's solution
- Submit someone else's project
- Use an externally developed solution
- Present a previously completed application as their hackathon work
- Misrepresent the origin of their work

Using frameworks, libraries, APIs, templates and AI tools is allowed.

Using resources is allowed. Submitting an already completed solution is not.

10 / MVP REQUIREMENT

Teams are not expected to build a fully production-ready product within three hours. The focus should be on creating a functional MVP that clearly solves the given problem.

A strong submission should demonstrate:

PROBLEM	SOLUTION	WORKING FLOW	RESULT
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Core functionality should be prioritized over unnecessary features.

11 / SUBMISSION

Each team must submit its final solution before the official deadline. What is expected:

ITEM	STATUS	DETAILS
Live Demo	MANDATORY	Every team must demonstrate its working MVP live to the judges.
Short Video	RECOMMENDED	A short demo video of your MVP is strongly encouraged as a backup and a clear walkthrough.
Short Presentation	Optional	A few slides covering the problem, solution and what you would build next.
Source Code / Repository	Optional	Share if the organizers request it in the submission instructions.
Product & Technical Explanation	Optional	A brief note on what you built and how it works.

Exact submission instructions will be announced by the organizing team.

12 / FINAL DEMO

Each team must be prepared to demonstrate its solution to the judges. The demo should clearly explain:

- 1 What problem are you solving?
- 2 How does your solution work?
- 3 What did your team build?
- 4 Where is AI / technology being used?
- 5 What makes your solution useful?
- 6 What would you build next with more time?

Judges may test the MVP using different inputs during the evaluation.

13 / JUDGING

Teams will be evaluated on:

Problem Understanding

How well the team understands and addresses the given problem.

Working MVP

How much of the proposed solution actually works.

Technical Implementation

Quality of the architecture, code, integrations and technical approach.

Innovation & Creativity

How intelligently or differently the team approaches the problem.

Practical Applicability

Whether the solution could realistically provide value to its intended users.

UI/UX

How clear, usable and polished the MVP is.

Presentation & Understanding

How effectively the team demonstrates and explains its solution.

A large number of features does not automatically mean a better solution. A smaller working MVP is better than a large unfinished product.

14 / VENUE RULES

Participants must remain within the designated hackathon premises during the active competition period unless permission is granted by the organizing team.

Participants must follow:

- University rules
- Event security instructions
- Organizers' instructions
- Designated working-area rules

The organizing team will communicate any additional movement or room-access instructions during the event.

15 / DISQUALIFICATION

A team may be disqualified for serious violations, including:

- Using an unregistered fifth team member
- Receiving external human development assistance
- Copying another team's solution
- Sharing substantial code between competing teams
- Submitting someone else's project
- Misrepresenting previously developed work
- Manipulating the judging process
- Continuing development after the official time ends
- Violating official submission requirements
- Serious violation of venue or event rules

The organizing committee reserves the right to investigate suspected violations and make the final decision.

QUICK RULES

01	4 MEMBERS	Exactly four registered participants per team.
02	3 HOURS	Build your working MVP within the official development time.
03	SAME CHALLENGE	The problem statement will be provided by the organizers.
04	AI IS ALLOWED	ChatGPT, Claude, Cursor, Copilot, Gemini, Codex and other AI tools may be used.
05	BRING YOUR API KEYS	Arrange your own AI API keys before the event. OpenRouter free models can be used.
06	NO FIFTH PERSON	No unregistered person may contribute to the solution.
07	WORK INDEPENDENTLY	Competing teams cannot build or debug solutions for each other.
08	BUILD AN MVP	Focus on a working solution rather than a complete production product.
09	UNDERSTAND YOUR WORK	You must be able to explain your code and implementation to the judges.
10	LIVE DEMO IS MANDATORY	Short video is recommended. Presentation and other items are optional.
11	SUBMIT ON TIME	Development ends when the official time is over.
12	BUILD. DEMO. EXPLAIN.	Create something that works and be ready to prove it.

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Infinity Wave is a software house building mobile and web products, enterprise solutions and sports technology. Meta Technology Partner.

Good luck, teams. Build. Demo. Explain.